- Assess for lacerations/edema/hemorrhoids
- Assess for complications/hematoma

Nursing Intervention Sitz Bath: A rotating fluid that moves the water, may fit over the commode or one can be performed with no special equipment using the bathtub other than a bathing ring. Turn tub on and allow drain to open and use a ring for circulating water. It's very shallow and only bathes the perineal area.

H: Homan's Sign

- Assess for Signs of DVT by the Homan's Sign (Deep Vein Thrombosis)
- Inspect legs for signs of thromboembolism, and assess Homan's sign A
- Positive Homan's sign is indicative of DVT, although it's not the most reliable indicator

Performing the Homan's Test

- Most commonly performed with the supine position while laying in bed
- The calf is flexed at a 90° angle
- The nurse manipulates the foot in a dorsiflexion movement
- If pain is felt in the calf, the Homan's Sign is said to be positive

E: Emotional Status

- Fluctuations in estrogen levels are blamed for the emotional roller-coaster that many moms experience after birth
- High levels of stress, increased responsibility, and sleep deprivation exacerbate the emotion
- Bonding refers to the interactions between the mother and baby
- Caregiving of self and baby is an indicator of emotional status.

Preventing Infection

- Observe for elevated temperature above 38°C.
- Evaluate episiotomy/perineum for redness, ecchymosis, edema, discharge (colour, amount, odour) and approximation of the skin.
- Assess for pain, burning sensation, and frequency of urination.
- Administer antibiotics as ordered.

Reducing Fatigue

1. Provide a quiet and minimally disturbed environment.
2. Organize nursing care to keep interruptions to a minimum.
3. Encourage the woman to minimize visitors and phone calls.
4. Encourage the woman sleep while the baby is sleeping. (8-10 hours sleep).
5. Early ambulation.
6. Avoid strenuous activities for 6 weeks.

Minimizing Pain

- Instruct the woman to apply ice packs to the perineal area for the first 24 hours for perineal trauma or edema.
- Initiate the Sitz bath for perineal discomfort after the first 24 hours. Educate to do three times a day for 15 to 20 minutes.
- Instruct the woman to contract her buttocks before sitting to reduce perineal discomfort.

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